those of an important agglomeration."[41] The exquisitely decorated smaller mosque here, locally known as the Thamban Wari *masjid* ("the mosque of columns") (Figure 6.11), exemplifies the style and material of construction favored by the elite strata of the polities spanning Gujarat, Sindh, Makran, and southern Baluchistan; it was a mode of building that co-existed with the above-described localized traditions.

Jam Jaskars Goth's Thamban Wari *masjid* was paved with brick, though the rest of its structural fabric – including the eponymous columns – were hewn from locally available stone. More intact and roughly contemporaneous structures at the site of Bhadreshvar, along the Kachh coast of Gujarat, provide comparable examples of flat-roofed mosques (Figure 6.12) and tombs, some with corbeled "domes" (Figure 6.13). Thamban Wari *masjid* has received only scanty publication thus far, but it is apparent that its structural components were carved with a confident expertise, the multi-shafted columns consisting of square, circular, and eight- or sixteen-sided sections. Their decorative programs seemed to draw from an established iconography, including motifs of diamonds in series; crisply rendered but still lush foliage; keyhole niches; and most notably the stylized but recognizable overflowing pot motif (Skt. *purnaghata*) well known from the decorative iconographies of the region's temple and other architectures (Figure 6.14). Given the *masjid*'s stylistic continuity with the surviving stone temples of the area, the colonial-era archaeologist Henry Cousens assumed that it "had been constructed from the materials of a Hindu temple … [and] the Muhammadans chiseled out the images from the niches on the pillars."[42]



Figure 6.12 *Chhoti* masjid*, Bhadreshvar, Kachch District, Gujarat, India, interior, column. © Photograph Alka Patel 2001.*

In more recent scholarship, the mosque has been summarily compared with "the stone temples of the region and the … mosques and tombs constructed for maritime communities of Muslims".[43] But rather than